

Consulting English

Instructor guide for advanced ESL learners working in consulting

Audience: management consultants, strategy consultants, implementation consultants, analysts, engagement managers, client partners, internal consultants, and advisory teams

Focus: A consulting English curriculum for discovery, hypotheses, stakeholder management, scope, executive recommendations, slide narratives, implementation risk, and client pushback.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Purpose and Course Logic

A consulting English curriculum for discovery, hypotheses, stakeholder management, scope, executive recommendations, slide narratives, implementation risk, and client pushback.

Core language challenge

Advanced learners do not only need vocabulary. They need the ability to ask which standard applies, who owns the decision, what evidence is sufficient, what risk is being accepted, and how to disagree without sounding vague, defensive, or reckless.

Each module trains a realistic workplace pressure point with role-specific terms, decision language, pushback practice, and bounded decision activities learners can apply to their own work.

Course objectives

- Use consulting terminology accurately in meetings, written updates, handoffs, escalations, reviews, and client or stakeholder conversations.
- Turn vague requests into specific questions about evidence, owner, deadline, constraint, risk, and decision rights.
- Push back on unsafe, unsupported, noncompliant, unrealistic, or poorly scoped proposals while preserving professional trust.
- Handle realistic dialogues from the field, including conflict, uncertainty, documentation gaps, customer or stakeholder pressure, and cross-functional disagreement.
- Select language that produces concise workplace outputs: briefing notes, escalation updates, meeting scripts, risk memos, decision records, and follow-up messages.

Instructor Module Plans

Module 1. Client Discovery and Problem Definition (90 minutes)

Clarify the real problem before proposing work.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: discovery, problem statement, decision question, stakeholder.
- Explain the workplace tension: Decision question, stakeholders, constraints, and expected use of analysis need clarification.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Sell the requested benchmark.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a discovery question guide.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A client asks for a benchmark study but describes a decision problem.

Sell the requested benchmark.

Decision question, stakeholders, constraints, and expected use of analysis need clarification.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.

3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a discovery question guide.

Module 2. Hypotheses and Issue Trees (90 minutes)

Structure analysis without pretending certainty.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: hypothesis, issue tree, workstream, evidence plan.
- Explain the workplace tension: Hypotheses, issue tree, prioritization, and evidence plan should focus effort.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Analyze everything.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a issue-tree workplan.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

The team has limited data but needs a workplan.

Analyze everything.

Hypotheses, issue tree, prioritization, and evidence plan should focus effort.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a issue-tree workplan.

Module 3. Data Requests and Client Burden (90 minutes)

Ask for information efficiently and respectfully.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: data request, confidentiality, owner, deadline.
- Explain the workplace tension: Data relevance, owner, confidentiality, deadline, and burden need management.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Ask for everything just in case.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a data request prioritization.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

The consulting team sends a long data request to a busy client.

Ask for everything just in case.

Data relevance, owner, confidentiality, deadline, and burden need management.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.

2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a data request prioritization.

Module 4. Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis (90 minutes)

Turn analysis into a clear recommendation.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: storyline, so what, recommendation, decision ask.
- Explain the workplace tension: So-what, implication, recommendation, and decision ask must be explicit.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Add more detail.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a executive storyline.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A deck has many charts but no decision narrative.

Add more detail.

So-what, implication, recommendation, and decision ask must be explicit.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a executive storyline.

Module 5. Scope Management and Change Requests (90 minutes)

Protect scope while staying client-service oriented.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: scope, change request, tradeoff, statement of work.
- Explain the workplace tension: Scope, timeline, budget, value, and tradeoff need a formal conversation.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Do it to keep the client happy.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a scope-change response.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A client asks for an additional market study mid-project.

Do it to keep the client happy.

Scope, timeline, budget, value, and tradeoff need a formal conversation.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a scope-change response.

Module 6. Difficult Client Feedback (90 minutes)

Receive criticism without losing authority.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: assumption, implementation constraint, stakeholder buy-in, iteration.
- Explain the workplace tension: Implementation constraints, assumptions, and client knowledge should be integrated.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Defend the model.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a feedback recovery plan.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A client says the recommendation is not practical.

Defend the model.

Implementation constraints, assumptions, and client knowledge should be integrated.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a feedback recovery plan.

Module 7. Implementation and Change Management (90 minutes)

Move from recommendation to adoption risk.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: operating model, change management, adoption, decision rights.
- Explain the workplace tension: Change story, incentives, decision rights, training, and adoption metrics matter.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Tell managers the decision is final.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a implementation risk brief.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

Leadership approves a new operating model but managers resist.

Tell managers the decision is final.

Change story, incentives, decision rights, training, and adoption metrics matter.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a implementation risk brief.

Module 8. Steering Committees and Final Readouts (90 minutes)

Manage executive decisions and unresolved disagreement.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: steering committee, option set, risk, next step.
- Explain the workplace tension: Decision rights, options, risks, and next-step ownership need facilitation.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Keep presenting the slides.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a steering committee close.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

Executives disagree during the final readout.

Keep presenting the slides.

Decision rights, options, risks, and next-step ownership need facilitation.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a steering committee close.

Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

Client Discovery and Problem Definition

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
discovery	In consulting, discovery is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to clarify the real problem before proposing work.	clarify discovery; document discovery	Contrast: discovery should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify discovery and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
problem statement	In consulting, problem statement is a workplace communication artifact that records facts, interpretation, and the decision or action requested. Use it when teams need to clarify the real problem before proposing work.	prepare a problem statement; circulate the problem statement	Contrast: problem statement is a reviewable communication artifact, not an undocumented verbal assurance. Example: The problem statement should state the evidence, caveat, decision owner, and next action.
decision question	In consulting, decision question is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to clarify the real problem before proposing work.	clarify decision question; document decision question	Contrast: decision question should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify decision question and the evidence that supports it.
stakeholder	Person or group with an interest, risk, authority, or dependency in the work.	clarify stakeholder; document stakeholder	Contrast: stakeholder should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify stakeholder and the evidence that supports it.

Hypotheses and Issue Trees

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
hypothesis	In consulting, hypothesis is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to structure analysis without pretending certainty.	clarify hypothesis; document hypothesis	Contrast: hypothesis should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify hypothesis and the evidence that supports it.
issue tree	In consulting, issue tree is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to structure analysis without pretending certainty.	clarify issue tree; document issue tree	Contrast: issue tree should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify issue tree and the evidence that supports it.
workstream	In consulting, workstream is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to structure analysis without pretending certainty.	clarify workstream; document workstream	Contrast: workstream should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify workstream and the evidence that supports it.
evidence plan	In consulting, evidence plan is a structured course of action that assigns priorities, sequencing, assumptions, and responsible roles. Use it when teams need to structure analysis without pretending certainty.	align on the evidence plan; revise the evidence plan	Contrast: evidence plan sets an intended course of action; it is not proof that the work is feasible or approved. Example: Before we revise the evidence plan, we need to test the dependency and resource assumptions.

Data Requests and Client Burden

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
data request	In consulting, data request is a formal intake or routing mechanism that starts work, seeks a decision, or transfers responsibility. Use it when teams need to ask for information efficiently and respectfully.	clarify data request; document data request	Contrast: data request should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify data request and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
confidentiality	In consulting, confidentiality is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to ask for information efficiently and respectfully.	clarify confidentiality; document confidentiality	Contrast: confidentiality should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify confidentiality and the evidence that supports it.
owner	Named person or role accountable for a decision, action, deliverable, or risk.	clarify owner; document owner	Contrast: owner should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify owner and the evidence that supports it.
deadline	In consulting, deadline is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to ask for information efficiently and respectfully.	clarify deadline; document deadline	Contrast: deadline should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify deadline and the evidence that supports it.

Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
storyline	In consulting, storyline is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to turn analysis into a clear recommendation.	clarify storyline; document storyline	Contrast: storyline should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify storyline and the evidence that supports it.
so what	In consulting, so what is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to turn analysis into a clear recommendation.	clarify so what; document so what	Contrast: so what should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify so what and the evidence that supports it.
recommendation	In consulting, recommendation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to turn analysis into a clear recommendation.	clarify recommendation; document recommendation	Contrast: recommendation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify recommendation and the evidence that supports it.
decision ask	In consulting, decision ask is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to turn analysis into a clear recommendation.	clarify decision ask; document decision ask	Contrast: decision ask should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify decision ask and the evidence that supports it.

Scope Management and Change Requests

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
scope	Defined boundary of work, responsibility, deliverables, assumptions, and exclusions.	clarify scope; document scope	Contrast: scope should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify scope and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
change request	In consulting, change request is a formal intake or routing mechanism that starts work, seeks a decision, or transfers responsibility. Use it when teams need to protect scope while staying client-service oriented.	clarify change request; document change request	Contrast: change request should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify change request and the evidence that supports it.
tradeoff	In consulting, tradeoff is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to protect scope while staying client-service oriented.	clarify tradeoff; document tradeoff	Contrast: tradeoff should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify tradeoff and the evidence that supports it.
statement of work	In consulting, statement of work is a workplace communication artifact that records facts, interpretation, and the decision or action requested. Use it when teams need to protect scope while staying client-service oriented.	prepare a statement of work; circulate the statement of work	Contrast: statement of work is a reviewable communication artifact, not an undocumented verbal assurance. Example: The statement of work should state the evidence, caveat, decision owner, and next action.

Difficult Client Feedback

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
assumption	In consulting, assumption is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to receive criticism without losing authority.	clarify assumption; document assumption	Contrast: assumption should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify assumption and the evidence that supports it.
implementation constraint	In consulting, implementation constraint is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to receive criticism without losing authority.	clarify implementation constraint; document implementation constraint	Contrast: implementation constraint should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify implementation constraint and the evidence that supports it.
stakeholder buy-in	In consulting, stakeholder buy-in is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to receive criticism without losing authority.	clarify stakeholder buy-in; document stakeholder buy-in	Contrast: stakeholder buy-in should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify stakeholder buy-in and the evidence that supports it.
iteration	In consulting, iteration is a measurable indicator used to quantify performance, exposure, capacity, quality, or change over time. Use it when teams need to receive criticism without losing authority.	track iteration; explain a change in iteration	Contrast: iteration measures a result or condition; it does not, by itself, prove the cause. Example: Before we act, let us track iteration by segment and explain what changed.

Implementation and Change Management

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
operating model	How work is organized across people, process, technology, governance, and metrics.	clarify operating model; document operating model	Contrast: operating model should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify operating model and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
change management	In consulting, change management is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to move from recommendation to adoption risk.	clarify change management; document change management	Contrast: change management should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify change management and the evidence that supports it.
adoption	In consulting, adoption is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to move from recommendation to adoption risk.	clarify adoption; document adoption	Contrast: adoption should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify adoption and the evidence that supports it.
decision rights	In consulting, decision rights is a decision-accountability mechanism that clarifies who recommends, approves, performs, and accepts risk. Use it when teams need to move from recommendation to adoption risk.	clarify decision rights; document decision rights	Contrast: decision rights should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify decision rights and the evidence that supports it.

Steering Committees and Final Readouts

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
steering committee	In consulting, steering committee is a decision-accountability mechanism that clarifies who recommends, approves, performs, and accepts risk. Use it when teams need to manage executive decisions and unresolved disagreement.	clarify steering committee; document steering committee	Contrast: steering committee should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify steering committee and the evidence that supports it.
option set	In consulting, option set is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to manage executive decisions and unresolved disagreement.	clarify option set; document option set	Contrast: option set should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify option set and the evidence that supports it.
risk	In consulting, risk is a condition or event that can create harm, loss, noncompliance, delay, or unacceptable performance. Use it when teams need to manage executive decisions and unresolved disagreement.	assess risk; mitigate risk	Contrast: risk identifies a possible or current exposure; it is not the same as accepting that exposure. Example: We need to assess risk, name the owner, and agree on the trigger for escalation.
next step	In consulting, next step is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to manage executive decisions and unresolved disagreement.	clarify next step; document next step	Contrast: next step should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify next step and the evidence that supports it.

Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

Situation	Useful language
Client Discovery and Problem Definition	Before we commit, I want to confirm discovery, problem statement, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If decision question, stakeholders, constraints, and expected use of analysis need clarification., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.

Situation	Useful language
Hypotheses and Issue Trees	Before we commit, I want to confirm hypothesis, issue tree, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If hypotheses, issue tree, prioritization, and evidence plan should focus effort., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Data Requests and Client Burden	Before we commit, I want to confirm data request, confidentiality, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If data relevance, owner, confidentiality, deadline, and burden need management., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis	Before we commit, I want to confirm storyline, so what, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If so-what, implication, recommendation, and decision ask must be explicit., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Scope Management and Change Requests	Before we commit, I want to confirm scope, change request, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If scope, timeline, budget, value, and tradeoff need a formal conversation., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Difficult Client Feedback	Before we commit, I want to confirm assumption, implementation constraint, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If implementation constraints, assumptions, and client knowledge should be integrated., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Implementation and Change Management	Before we commit, I want to confirm operating model, change management, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If change story, incentives, decision rights, training, and adoption metrics matter., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Steering Committees and Final Readouts	Before we commit, I want to confirm steering committee, option set, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If decision rights, options, risks, and next-step ownership need facilitation., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.

High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

Assessment and Coaching

Performance rubric

Skill	Developing	Proficient	Strong
Terminology	Recognizes terms but uses them loosely.	Uses field terms accurately in context.	Defines terms, connects them to evidence, and explains decision impact.
Pushback	Disagrees vaguely or avoids disagreement.	Names concern with evidence and next step.	Balances urgency, relationship, risk, owner, and decision rights.
Scenario judgment	Focuses on one stakeholder's preference.	Identifies constraint, risk, and process.	Guides the group toward a documented, realistic decision.
Decision communication	Selects language without linking it to the decision.	Chooses language that names facts, owner, and next step.	Distinguishes evidence, tradeoff, authority, and escalation in a decision-ready response.

Source orientation

- Statement of work and client confidentiality terms.

- Firm quality standards and slide-review practices.
- Client data-governance and decision-making protocols.
- The learner's own company policies, SOPs, contracts, systems, templates, and approved communication standards.